

T08 B ENHANCED OPERABLE WINDOWS | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Provide the benefits of increased outdoor air supply while minimizing any resulting thermal discomfort.

Summary : This WELL feature requires windows that can be opened at different elevations to provide desired air flow at different outdoor temperatures.

Issue : Although use of personally controlled operable windows can improve satisfaction with the indoor air quality and thermal comfort, it may also have negative aspects if outdoor air is polluted or if outdoor weather is very hot or cold.¹⁻³ In cold weather, large openings in windows near occupants can lead to unpleasant draft.

Solutions : Windows which can be opened in multiple modes may provide thermal comfort over a variety of weather conditions. Large openings near the level of the occupants can provide high levels of air exchange and potentially increased air speed and corresponding cooling effect. Small openings near the ceiling allow some air exchange to take place while minimizing the potential for draft, allowing the outdoor air to warm before it reaches the occupants.⁴

PART 1 PROVIDE WINDOWS WITH MULTIPLE OPENING MODES (MAX : 1 PT)

Note : Projects may only achieve this part if Feature A07 Part 1 is also achieved.

For All Spaces:

1: Window design

Operable windows may be opened according to the following requirements (windows which may be opened in both modes may count for both requirements a and b):

- a. At least 70% of operable windows may be opened such that at least half of the opening is not more than 1.8 m above the finished floor and opening is at least 0.3 m in the smallest dimension. At least one such window is present in each room with operable windows.
- b. If project is equipped with heating, at least 30% of operable windows may be opened such that entirety of opening is at least 1.8 m above the finished floor (preferably as close to the ceiling as possible).⁵ At least one such window is present in each room with operable windows.
- c. Controls for window operation are positioned not more than 1.7 m above the finished floor.

Note : This feature is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.

2: Window operation

Instructions for window operation are provided through signage or other communications to regular occupants to indicate the following:

- a. Windows with low openings are to be used during mild and/or warm weather.
- b. Windows are not to be opened when mechanical cooling is in operation (not required if no mechanical cooling is present or if mechanical cooling system is configured to disengage automatically when windows are open).
- c. Windows with high openings (if present) are to be used in cold weather.

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